

Inferring Institutional Learning from Ministerial Duration: A Deductive Framework with Evidence from Peru, 1821–2026

Jose Manuel Magallanes Reyes

Departamento de Ciencias Sociales e Instituto PULSO
Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú

Abstract

How do governmental organizations accumulate institutional knowledge despite recurrent political change? Existing research has explained long-term political development through concepts such as Critical Junctures and path dependence, yet has devoted comparatively less attention to the organizational conditions under which institutional learning becomes possible. This paper develops a deductive framework linking four latent theoretical constructs—organizational continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, institutional learning, and Protective Belts—to their observable empirical implications. Political Frameworks are introduced as historically grounded environments generated by successive Critical Junctures, while Protective Belts are conceptualized as organization-specific constraint structures that selectively preserve organizational continuity within the same historical environment. Because these theoretical constructs are not directly observable, the empirical analyses employ ministerial duration as an indicator of the conditions under which organizational knowledge may accumulate. The framework is evaluated using an original dataset of 1,062 ministerial spells covering five governmental organizations in Peru between 1821 and 2026. Kaplan–Meier estimates and Cox proportional hazards models provide qualified support for the theoretical propositions. Political Frameworks explain important historical differences in ministerial continuity but do not generate a monotonic historical progression. Within the post-1993 Political Framework, the Ministry of Economy and Finance exhibits comparatively greater organizational continuity following the consolidation of Peru’s macroeconomic governance, consistent with the proposed role of Protective Belts. Beyond the Peruvian case, the paper contributes a deductive framework that integrates comparative-historical institutionalism and organizational theory by distinguishing historical environments from the organizational mechanisms through which institutional learning develops.

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“Se vogliamo che tutto rimanga
com’è, bisogna che tutto cambi.”

Il Gattopardo

Giuseppe Tomasi di Lampedusa,
1958

Introduction

Governing is hard. Education, health, public safety, and economic development are not technical problems with known solutions, but complex social challenges that demand sustained institutional effort. Good policy takes time to design, time to implement, and even longer to produce visible social outcomes. Good practices diffuse gradually. Organizations accumulate knowledge slowly. Institutional learning emerges only when that accumulated knowledge is preserved, transmitted, and refined across successive administrations. Citizens experience meaningful change only after years of coherent action in the same direction. In the long run, successful governance depends less on isolated political decisions than on the organizational conditions that allow knowledge to persist beyond individual officeholders.

After more than two hundred years of republican life, the Peruvian political class has repeatedly changed governments, cabinets, constitutions, and political coalitions. Yet the underlying pattern remains remarkably stable. Each new administration appoints a cabinet whose members understand, implicitly or explicitly, the terms of their engagement: they are expected to manage complexity on behalf of the president, but they may also be sacrificed whenever political pressure demands a visible response. Their departure rarely resolves the conflict that triggered it. The resignation of a premier or any other minister may relieve immediate pressure, but it seldom addresses the underlying causes of crisis. Cabinet reshuffles therefore signal political responsiveness without necessarily producing institutional correction.

This persistence should not be mistaken for an absence of adaptation. Political actors continuously learn how to navigate constitutional ambiguities, manage public blame, and deploy ministerial replacement as a mechanism for absorbing political pressure. Yet this adaptation has been primarily political rather than organizational. Governments have become increasingly proficient at reproducing established responses to recurring crises instead of transforming the organizational conditions under which governing takes place. Governments change. Ministers change. Yet the institutional repertoire through which political instability is managed remains remarkably stable. This cycle has characterized much of Peru’s republican history.

Political scientists often describe this type of persistence through the concept of path dependence, whereby accumulated institutional choices progressively constrain subsequent alternatives. Yet paths do break. As Krznaric (2024) argues, transformative institutional change typically requires the convergence of a major crisis, political actors capable of exploiting that crisis, and a compelling institutional alternative. France’s transition to the Fifth Republic illustrates this dynamic. The Algerian War, Gaullism, and constitutional redesign converged to produce a durable transformation of executive institutions. More importantly, the Fifth Republic fundamentally altered the conditions under which political continuity was produced, replacing chronic executive instability with a markedly more stable pattern of government.

Prior to the Fifth Republic, France exhibited levels of executive instability comparable to those observed throughout much of Peru’s republican history. Figure 1 illustrates this similarity. Peru reached twenty-three premier appointments during the 1890s, while France reached twenty during the 1930s. After 1958, however, the trajectories diverged sharply. French premier appointments declined to a stable range of three to six per decade and have remained there ever since, whereas Peru gradually returned to levels characteristic of the nineteenth century. Peru has experienced numerous Critical Junctures—including independence without effective state-building, the War of the Pacific, hyperinflation, political violence, the collapse of the Fujimori regime, and the prolonged constitutional crisis beginning in 2016—each creating the possibility of a new Political Framework and, consequently, new organizational conditions for institutional learning.

The central question, however, is not whether institutional change occurred. Peru’s republican history is full of constitutional reforms, regime transitions, and political ruptures. The more fundamental question is whether these transformations altered the organizational conditions under which knowledge could be preserved, accumulated, and transmitted over time. From this perspective, a Critical Juncture matters not simply because it generates new institutional arrangements, but because it may establish a durable Political Framework within which different governmental organizations confront different opportunities for organizational continuity and institutional learning. France appears to have experienced such a transformation after 1958. Peru’s trajectory raises the possibility that institutional innovation and organizational learning do not necessarily coincide.

This paper addresses that question by treating ministerial continuity as the observable implication of broader organizational processes. Ministerial duration is not interpreted as institutional learning itself. Rather, it provides an empirical indicator of the organizational conditions under which organizational knowledge may accumulate. Organizations do not preserve knowledge because particular individuals remain indefinitely in office. Instead, sustained continuity creates opportunities for organizational routines, institutional memory, policy procedures, and accumulated expertise to be retained, transmitted, and refined despite inevitable personnel turnover. Ministerial continuity therefore constitutes a necessary—although not sufficient—condition

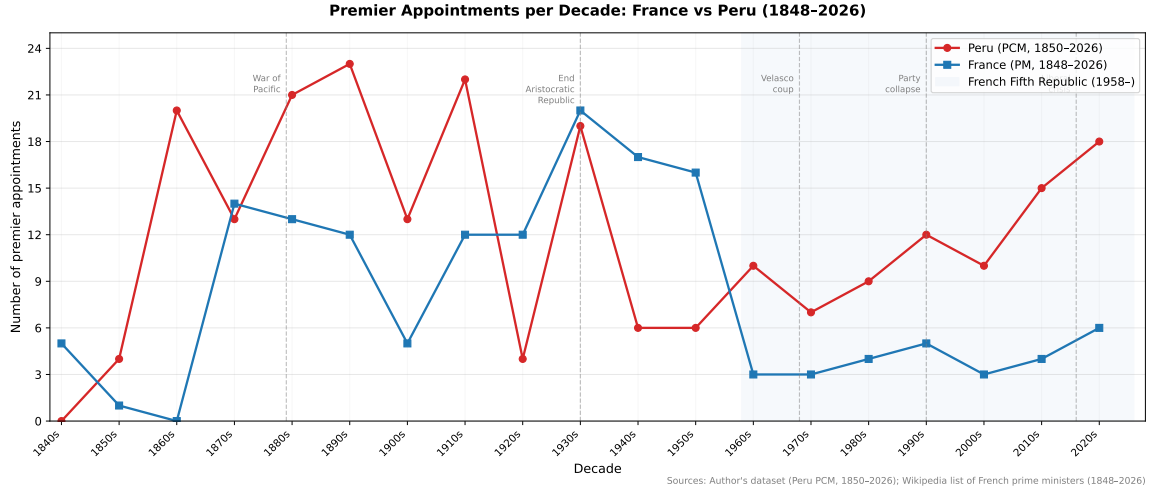


Figure 1

Premier Appointments per Decade: France vs. Peru, 1848–2026.

Sources: Author's dataset (based on Gálvez Montero and García Vega (2016a, 2016b)); Wikipedia list of French prime ministers (1848–2026).

for organizational knowledge accumulation and institutional learning.

Political science has traditionally examined these issues through largely separate research traditions. Ministerial duration has been studied using survival and event-history methods, whereas long-term institutional development has primarily been examined through the comparative-historical literature on Critical Junctures and path dependence. This paper bridges these traditions by developing a deductive framework that distinguishes latent organizational constructs from their observable empirical implications. Within this framework, ministerial duration serves as the observable indicator through which propositions about organizational continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, institutional learning, and Protective Belts are empirically evaluated.

The empirical strategy follows directly from the deductive framework developed in the following sections. Two propositions generate distinct observable implications. The first evaluates historical variation across Political Frameworks, examining whether successive historical environments generated progressively more favorable organizational conditions for continuity and institutional learning. The second evaluates organizational variation within Political Frameworks, recognizing that governmental organizations operating under the same historical environment may nevertheless experience different patterns of organizational continuity because they are embedded within different Protective Belts. Together, these propositions distinguish historical environments from organization-specific mechanisms as complementary explanations of institutional learning.

The question guiding this study is therefore: *How do Political Frameworks and*

Protective Belts jointly shape the organizational conditions under which institutional learning becomes possible?

This question cannot be answered directly because organizational knowledge accumulation and institutional learning are latent theoretical constructs that cannot be observed in historical records. Instead, the empirical analyses evaluate their observable implications through ministerial continuity. If organizational continuity constitutes a necessary condition for organizational knowledge accumulation, then systematic differences in ministerial duration provide observable evidence about differences in the organizational conditions under which knowledge may be preserved, accumulated, and transmitted over time.

The deductive framework developed in the following sections translates this general question into two observable propositions. The first evaluates whether ministerial continuity differs systematically across successive Political Frameworks, thereby examining historical variation in the organizational conditions for institutional learning. The second evaluates whether governmental organizations operating within the same Political Framework exhibit systematically different patterns of ministerial continuity, thereby assessing the role of organization-specific Protective Belts.

To evaluate these propositions, we construct an original longitudinal dataset of 1,062 ministerial spells covering the period from 1821 to 2026. The empirical analyses focus on five governmental organizations representing distinct executive functions: the Presidency of the Council of Ministers (PCM), the Ministry of Economy and Finance (MEF), and the Ministries of Interior, Education, and Health. Ministerial spells are subsequently organized according to the Political Frameworks derived from Peru’s successive Critical Junctures (Lopez Jimenez et al., 2025). Kaplan–Meier estimates and Cox proportional hazards models are then used to evaluate the observable implications of the two propositions, providing empirical evidence on how historical environments and organization-specific mechanisms jointly shape the organizational conditions under which institutional learning develops.

1 Literature Review

The political science literature on ministerial survival has converged around two broad families of explanations. The first explains variation in ministerial tenure through characteristics of ministers themselves. The second emphasizes the political and institutional environments within which ministers operate. Table 1 summarizes the principal covariates identified across the core studies.

1.1 Trait-Based Explanations of Ministerial Survival

Trait-based approaches explain ministerial survival through characteristics of the officeholder. The comparative literature has identified a wide range of individual attributes that influence ministers’ probability of remaining in office, including ideological proximity to the executive, partisan affiliation, portfolio importance, min-

Table 1*Trait-based and Context-based Predictors of Ministerial Survival*

Author(s)	Trait-based	Context-based
Huber & Martinez-Gallardo (2008)	Ideological distance from government center; PM party membership; portfolio importance	Coalition type; minority government; electoral volatility; party fractionalization
Dewan & Dowding (2005)	Resignation issue salience; ministerial seniority	PM support level; media attention; single-party vs. coalition system
Fischer et al. (2012)	Age; education; gender; portfolio rank	PM popularity; regime type; frequency of resignation calls
Camerlo & Pérez-Liñán (2015)	Portfolio type; technocrat/partisan/outsider profile; first cabinet appointment	Protests; scandals; electoral calendar; term limits; reelection rules
Feliú Ribeiro & López Burian (2023)	Technical expertise; presidential group membership; prior electoral experience (<i>risk factor</i>)	Economic growth; GDP per capita; legislative powers; regime type; portfolio area
Mejía et al. (2021)	Education; gender; regional origin; prior elected office	Coalition type; legislative majority; party-system change
Avendaño & Dávila (2012)	Ministerial experience; political career trajectory; accumulated political capital	Coalition management; party balance; presidential strategy; policy-management problems

isterial seniority, age, education, gender, and previous political experience (Dewan & Dowding, 2005; Fischer et al., 2012; Huber & Martinez-Gallardo, 2008).

Recent research has extended these explanations by examining the organizational and political resources ministers bring to office. Feliú Ribeiro and López Burian find that technical expertise and membership in presidential networks increase ministerial survival, whereas prior electoral experience may paradoxically increase the risk of dismissal (Feliú Ribeiro & López Burian, 2023). Analyzing four Latin American countries between 1945 and 2020, they show that career politicians are often more vulnerable to replacement than technocrats, suggesting that political leaders value different forms of expertise depending on the portfolio and governing context.

Taken together, these studies indicate that ministerial survival depends partly on who ministers are. Professional backgrounds, political careers, ideological proximity, technical expertise, and personal resources all shape survival prospects. Yet these characteristics rarely operate independently. Their effects are conditioned by the institutional and political environments within which ministers serve, leading to the second major family of explanations.

1.2 Context-Based Explanations of Ministerial Survival

Context-based approaches explain ministerial survival through characteristics of the political and institutional environment rather than characteristics of individual ministers. Ministers survive or leave office because the incentives governing executive appointments and dismissals are shaped by the broader political context.

The comparative literature consistently identifies coalition dynamics as a central determinant of ministerial duration. Coalition type, minority government status, electoral volatility, and party-system fragmentation all influence the likelihood of ministerial replacement independently of individual characteristics (Huber & Martinez-Gallardo, 2008). Likewise, political crises, scandals, protests, electoral calendars, and constitutional term limits alter the strategic incentives presidents face when deciding whether to retain or dismiss ministers (Camerlo & Pérez-Liñán, 2015). Broader institutional and economic conditions also shape survival probabilities by modifying the political environment within which governments operate (Feliú Ribeiro & López Burian, 2023).

Country studies illustrate how these contextual mechanisms operate in practice. For Colombia, Mejía Guinand et al. show that constitutional reforms, changes in the party system, and coalition arrangements redefine the institutional environment governing ministerial careers, conditioning the effects of individual characteristics (Mejía et al., 2021). Similarly, Avendaño and Dávila demonstrate that cabinet rotation during Chile’s Concertación governments functioned primarily as an instrument of coalition management rather than as a response to individual ministerial performance. Despite frequent cabinet reshuffles, finance ministers consistently exhibited the longest tenures, reflecting the strategic importance of maintaining macroeconomic credibility and coalition equilibrium (Avendaño & Dávila, 2012).

Recent research has also refined the contextual analysis of ministerial portfolios. Camerlo and Martínez-Gallardo argue that traditional measures of portfolio importance obscure important functional differences among ministries. They propose evaluating portfolios according to dimensions such as policy-management capacity, discretionary resource allocation, political agenda influence, and inter-portfolio coordination authority, thereby explaining why similar political environments may generate different survival incentives across ministries (Camerlo & Gallardo, 2022).

Taken together, these studies demonstrate that ministerial survival depends not only on who ministers are but also on the political environments within which they operate. Coalition dynamics, institutional arrangements, political crises, economic conditions, and portfolio characteristics jointly define the opportunities and constraints governing ministerial continuity.

1.3 Interpreting Ministerial Duration

The two families of explanations are not competing research programs. Virtually every empirical study combines individual and contextual covariates, with po-

litical environments conditioning the effects of ministerial characteristics. Together, these studies provide a rich understanding of why some ministers survive longer than others. Less attention, however, has been devoted to a different question: *what does ministerial duration actually represent?* Although the literature generally treats ministerial survival as the dependent variable, the theoretical processes that duration is assumed to reflect differ substantially across studies. Table 2 summarizes these alternative interpretations.

Table 2

Theoretical Processes Inferred from Ministerial Duration

Author(s)	Ministerial duration interpreted as evidence of...
Huber & Martinez-Gallardo (2008)	principal-agent selection, monitoring, and ministerial competence.
Dewan & Dowding (2005)	political accountability and executive blame management.
Fischer et al. (2012)	ministerial durability (the latent propensity to survive).
Camerlo & Pérez-Liñán (2015)	strategic executive adaptation under political and electoral constraints.
Feliú Ribeiro & López Burian (2023)	foreign-policy credibility and strategic stability.
Mejía et al. (2021)	coalition development and government stability.
Avendaño & Dávila (2012)	coalition governability through adaptive cabinet management.

The diversity of these interpretations reveals an important commonality. Ministerial duration is rarely regarded as theoretically meaningful in itself. Rather, it serves as an observable indicator of broader political processes, including executive accountability, coalition management, strategic adaptation, institutional durability, and policy credibility. In other words, the theoretical significance of ministerial duration depends on the process it is assumed to represent.

This common orientation leaves unexplored a different analytical possibility. Rather than interpreting continuity primarily as evidence of political strategy or institutional equilibrium, ministerial continuity may instead be understood as the observable organizational condition under which governments preserve accumulated knowledge and institutional learning becomes possible..

This paper adopts that alternative perspective. Ministerial continuity is not interpreted as institutional learning itself, nor does it imply that organizational knowledge resides in individual ministers. Rather, continuity provides the organizational condition under which knowledge embedded in routines, procedures, institutional memory, and accumulated administrative experience may be preserved, transmitted, and refined over time despite inevitable personnel turnover. Governmental organizations, rather than individual officeholders, therefore constitute the principal locus

through which organizational knowledge accumulates.

This reinterpretation shifts the analytical focus from explaining why ministers survive to understanding what organizational continuity enables governmental organizations to accomplish. Rather than treating ministerial duration as the phenomenon to be explained, the paper interprets observed continuity as an observable implication of broader organizational processes through which institutional learning may develop.

The next section develops the deductive theoretical framework. Three axioms establish the relationships among organizational continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, and institutional learning. Building upon these foundations, two propositions derive the observable implications evaluated in the empirical analyses. The first concerns historical variation across Political Frameworks, whereas the second concerns organizational variation associated with Protective Belts operating within the same Political Framework.

2 Theoretical Framework

The theoretical framework developed in this paper follows an axiomatic–deductive strategy. Rather than beginning with statistical hypotheses, it begins by specifying a set of latent theoretical constructs, the fundamental relationships connecting them, and the structural constraints under which those relationships operate. These relationships are expressed as axioms. They are not empirical hypotheses and therefore are not themselves subjected to statistical testing. Instead, they define the theoretical ontology from which observable propositions are deductively derived.

The propositions translate the latent theoretical relationships into observable historical implications that may be examined empirically. Consequently, the empirical analyses developed later do not test the axioms directly. Rather, they evaluate whether the observable implications derived from the propositions are consistent with the historical evidence.

This distinction is fundamental to the methodological strategy adopted throughout the paper. Theoretical constructs define the ontology of the framework. Axioms specify the enabling relationships among those constructs together with the structural constraints under which they operate. Propositions express those relationships in terms of observable historical features. Statistical analyses therefore evaluate the propositions, while the axioms provide the theoretical interpretation of the observed patterns. In this sense, the empirical analyses neither verify nor falsify the axioms themselves; instead, they assess the extent to which the observable evidence is consistent with the deductive framework.

Throughout the discussion, arrows ($\rightarrow$) denote deductive theoretical relationships rather than estimated causal effects. Unless explicitly stated otherwise, they should be interpreted as expressing enabling or necessary relationships among the constructs composing the theoretical framework.

2.1 Observables

The theoretical framework developed in this paper is formulated in terms of latent organizational processes operating under latent structural constraints. Because these constructs cannot be observed directly, empirical evaluation necessarily relies on observable historical features. These observables play two distinct roles. Some approximate the organizational processes specified by the axioms, whereas others operationalize the structural constraints under which those processes unfold.

2.1.1 Measures

The ministerial survival literature has traditionally relied on ministerial duration as its principal observable. This paper adopts the same measure. Ministerial duration is not interpreted as organizational continuity itself, but as an observable approximation of the continuity conditions under which organizational knowledge may accumulate. The empirical analyses developed later therefore evaluate the extent to which this conventional measure supports the theoretical expectations derived from the proposed organizational framework.

2.1.2 Constraints

Observable historical features also operationalize the structural constraints under which the proposed organizational processes unfold. These constraints do not constitute the organizational processes themselves; rather, they define the historical and organizational environments within which those processes are expected to exhibit greater or lesser explanatory power.

The first constraint structure is represented by **Political Frameworks (PF)**. Organizational continuity and organizational knowledge accumulation occur within a given institutional environment. Institutional learning, however, is inherently comparative. It cannot be inferred from continuity observed at a single point in time, but from whether continuity conditions differ across successive institutional environments. Any theory of institutional learning therefore requires historically meaningful units through which organizational continuity can be compared over time.

The comparative-historical literature provides such units through the concepts of critical junctures and path dependence. Critical junctures identify relatively brief periods during which political choices acquire unusually enduring consequences, whereas the path-dependent periods that follow constitute comparatively stable institutional environments (Capoccia & Kelemen, 2007; Collier & Munck, 2022). These path-dependent environments define the historical context within which governmental organizations preserve, interrupt, or rebuild organizational continuity. Consequently, this framework defines *Political Frameworks* as the latent historical constraint structures generated by completed Critical Junctures. Empirically, Political Frameworks are operationalized through historically bounded institutional periods, while theoretically they represent the historical environments under which the organizational

processes proposed by the axioms unfold.

The second constraint structure is represented by **Protective Belts (PB)**. Whereas Political Frameworks characterize the historical environment shared by all governmental organizations, they cannot explain why organizations operating under the same Political Framework often exhibit markedly different continuity conditions. A complementary organizational constraint is therefore required. Protective Belts refer to latent organizational constraint structures composed of institutional, political, administrative, and societal mechanisms that preserve the conditions under which organizational knowledge can accumulate. They do not protect individual officeholders, nor do they guarantee organizational continuity. Rather, they increase the costs associated with disrupting organizational routines, thereby creating organizational environments more conducive to preserving accumulated knowledge.

The concept of Protective Belts synthesizes several complementary theoretical traditions. Organizational sociology emphasizes that complex organizations develop systems of regulation and interdependence that reduce arbitrary organizational disruption (Crozier & Thoenig, 1976). Historical institutionalism explains how increasing returns progressively raise the costs of reversing accumulated organizational capabilities (Pierson, 2000). Bureaucratic politics demonstrates how governmental organizations acquire reputational capital and external constituencies that make political intervention increasingly costly (Carpenter, 2020). Finally, institutional theories of political decision-making emphasize that institutional configurations constrain discretionary political action by imposing unequal costs on organizational change (Tsebelis, 1995). Together, these perspectives explain how governmental organizations may become differentially protected despite operating within the same Political Framework.

Evidence consistent with this organizational logic also appears in the ministerial survival literature. For example, Feliú Ribeiro and López Burian argue that some ministerial portfolios are embedded within broader political and international accountability structures that increase the costs associated with organizational disruption (Feliú Ribeiro & López Burian, 2023). Although they do not formulate the concept of a Protective Belt explicitly, their analysis illustrates how different governmental organizations may operate under different organizational constraint structures.

Together, Political Frameworks and Protective Belts define the latent constraint structures under which the organizational processes specified by the axioms operate. Political Frameworks provide the historical environments within which organizational processes unfold, whereas Protective Belts characterize the organizational conditions under which those processes may develop more or less successfully. The axioms developed below specify the organizational relationships operating under these complementary constraints.

2.2 Axiom A1: Organizational Continuity Enables Organizational Knowledge Accumulation

The first axiom establishes the organizational foundation of the theoretical framework. Governmental organizations are temporal entities. Unlike isolated political decisions, organizational processes unfold through repeated interaction, the preservation of routines, and the retention of institutional memory. Consequently, *organizational continuity*—the persistence of organizational routines, procedures, institutional memory, and administrative practices despite the inevitable turnover of individual officeholders—provides the necessary condition under which *organizational knowledge accumulation*, understood as the progressive embedding of experience into those organizational processes, may occur.

The first axiom is stated as

$$C \rightarrow K \quad \text{s.t. } PF, PB \quad (A1)$$

Axiom A1 should be interpreted as expressing an enabling organizational relationship operating under the historical and organizational constraints represented by Political Frameworks and Protective Belts rather than as a deterministic causal claim. Organizational continuity enables organizational knowledge accumulation by allowing experience to be retained, articulated, transmitted, and progressively incorporated into organizational routines. It does not imply that organizations necessarily learn, innovate, or improve. The axiom identifies continuity as a necessary organizational condition for knowledge accumulation, not as a sufficient condition for organizational success.

Although presented here as an axiomatic premise, Axiom A1 is consistent with several independent theoretical traditions. The organizational learning literature argues that knowledge becomes progressively embedded through repeated interaction, retention, and routinization rather than isolated decisions (Levitt & March, 1988; Nonaka, 1998). Likewise, public policy scholars emphasize that governmental action relies upon accumulated routines and standard operating procedures that develop only through sustained organizational continuity (Allison, 1969; Foss & Foss, 2005; Lindblom, 1959). Although these traditions address different substantive questions, they converge on the same organizational principle: organizational continuity constitutes a necessary condition for organizational knowledge accumulation.

2.3 Axiom A2: Organizational Knowledge Accumulation Enables Institutional Learning

Axiom A1 established organizational continuity as the necessary condition under which governmental organizations accumulate knowledge. A second question naturally follows. Even if organizations accumulate knowledge over time, under what conditions can political institutions themselves be said to learn?

For the purposes of this framework, *institutional learning* refers to the capacity of political institutions to improve governing practices by incorporating accumulated organizational knowledge into subsequent institutional arrangements. Institutional learning is therefore conceived as an institutional property emerging from organizational processes rather than from the experiences of individual political actors.

The second axiom is stated as

$$K \rightarrow IL \quad \text{s.t. } PF, PB \quad (\text{A2})$$

Axiom A2 should be interpreted as expressing an enabling organizational relationship operating under the historical and organizational constraints represented by Political Frameworks and Protective Belts rather than as a deterministic causal claim. Organizational knowledge provides the experiential foundation upon which institutional learning may occur, but it does not guarantee that political institutions will adapt successfully or improve their governing capacity. Institutional learning therefore requires more than accumulated experience; it also depends upon how organizations preserve, interpret, and incorporate that experience into future governing practices.

Although presented here as an axiomatic premise, Axiom A2 is likewise consistent with several independent theoretical traditions. Organizational learning scholars distinguish the accumulation of organizational experience from learning itself, emphasizing that learning requires knowledge to become embedded in organizational routines and shared understandings (Fiol & Lyles, 1985). Institutional and policy learning theories similarly argue that political institutions adapt by preserving, interpreting, and revising accumulated organizational knowledge over time rather than merely reacting to isolated political events (Hall, 1993; Olsen, 2010). Although these traditions approach institutional adaptation from different analytical perspectives, they converge on the same principle: institutional learning presupposes the prior accumulation of organizational knowledge.

2.4 From Latent Theory to Observable Propositions

Axioms A1 and A2 specify the latent organizational process proposed by the theoretical framework. Because these relationships cannot be observed directly, empirical evaluation requires translating them into observable propositions. Throughout this paper, ministerial duration serves as an observable indicator of organizational continuity, while Political Frameworks and governmental organizations operationalize the historical and organizational constraint structures under which the proposed organizational process unfolds. Consequently, the propositions that follow are expressed exclusively in terms of observable historical features. Their theoretical interpretation is subsequently derived from Axioms A1 and A2.

2.4.1 *Proposition 1: Ministerial Duration across Political Frameworks*

The first proposition concerns historical variation in ministerial duration across successive Political Frameworks. Because institutional learning is inferred by comparing continuity conditions across historically distinct institutional environments, the relevant units of comparison are the Political Frameworks generated by completed Critical Junctures rather than the Critical Junctures themselves. Following established principles of concept formation and operationalization in comparative-historical research, Political Frameworks operationalize the observable historical environments within which governmental organizations operate (Capoccia & Kelemen, 2007; Collier & Munck, 2022). Consequently, the empirical analysis does not search inductively for historical breakpoints. Instead, it evaluates whether observed patterns of ministerial duration are consistent with a theoretically motivated historical periodization. The first proposition is therefore stated as

$$D_{f+1} > D_f, \quad f = 1, \dots, F - 1, \quad (\text{P1})$$

where D_f denotes the observed ministerial duration under Political Framework f , and F denotes the total number of Political Frameworks.

Observable implication. Successive Political Frameworks are expected to exhibit progressively longer patterns of ministerial duration.

Theoretical implication. According to Axioms A1 and A2, progressively longer patterns of ministerial duration are consistent with increasingly favorable conditions for organizational continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, and, consequently, institutional learning. Conversely, the absence of progressively longer duration patterns would suggest that successive Political Frameworks did not generate increasingly favorable conditions for organizational continuity and organizational knowledge accumulation.

2.4.2 *Proposition 2: Ministerial Duration across Governmental Organizations within Political Frameworks*

Whereas Proposition P1 concerns historical variation across Political Frameworks, the second proposition concerns organizational variation within Political Frameworks. If a Political Framework constitutes the common historical environment under which governmental organizations operate, then systematic differences in ministerial duration observed within the same Political Framework cannot be attributed to historical conditions alone. Instead, they suggest that governmental organizations operate under different organizational constraint structures.

The second proposition is therefore stated as

$$D_{of} \neq D_{o'f}, \quad o \neq o', \quad (\text{P2})$$

where D_{of} denotes the observed ministerial duration associated with governmental organization o operating under Political Framework f , and o and o' denote distinct governmental organizations.

Observable implication. Within the same Political Framework, ministerial duration is expected to vary systematically across governmental organizations.

Theoretical implication. According to Axioms A1 and A2, systematic differences in ministerial duration among governmental organizations operating under the same Political Framework are consistent with differences in the organizational conditions under which continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, and institutional learning may develop. Within the proposed framework, such differences are interpreted as evidence consistent with organizations operating under different configurations of Protective Belts.

3 Peru as an Empirical Application

The theoretical framework developed in the previous section proposes a general explanation linking organizational continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, and institutional learning under the historical and organizational constraints represented by Political Frameworks and Protective Belts. These concepts are not specific to Peru. Rather, they describe organizational processes that could, in principle, operate in any political system. Peru is therefore introduced not because the theory was derived from the Peruvian experience, but because its republican history provides a particularly informative empirical application through which the observable implications of the framework may be evaluated.

Peru is particularly suitable for this purpose for three reasons. First, its republican history encompasses multiple completed Critical Junctures, generating successive Political Frameworks through which organizational continuity can be compared across distinct historical environments. Second, despite repeated constitutional, political, and economic transformations, the executive branch has preserved a broadly stable ministerial organization, allowing organizational continuity to be observed within a stable institutional architecture over nearly two centuries. Third, the post-1990 period exhibits substantial variation in the organizational environments surrounding different governmental organizations, providing an opportunity to examine how organizations operating under the same Political Framework may nevertheless develop under different organizational constraint structures.

This application therefore illustrates the distinction developed in the theoretical framework between historical environments, represented by Political Frameworks, and organization-specific constraint structures, represented by Protective Belts.

From the perspective adopted here, Peru therefore constitutes a historically rich application rather than an exceptional case. The purpose is not to demonstrate that Peru followed a unique path of institutional development, but to evaluate whether the organizational processes proposed by the theory are consistent with a complex historical trajectory characterized by repeated institutional restructuring and differenti-

ated organizational development. Whether successive Political Frameworks generated increasingly favorable conditions for organizational continuity and whether different governmental organizations developed under different Protective Belts remain empirical questions rather than theoretical assumptions.

The following sections operationalize the observable features introduced in the theoretical framework. They first reconstruct the Political Frameworks generated by Peru’s completed Critical Junctures, thereby defining the historical environments within which organizational continuity is evaluated. They then operationalize the organizational mechanisms constituting the Protective Belt surrounding Peru’s macroeconomic governance and justify the comparative organizational design adopted for the empirical analysis. Together, these historical and organizational operationalizations establish the empirical setting through which the observable implications of Propositions P1 and P2 are evaluated.

3.1 Operationalizing Political Frameworks

The theoretical framework defines Political Frameworks as the latent historical constraint structures under which organizational continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, and institutional learning unfold. Their empirical application therefore requires an operationalization capable of representing historically distinct political environments.

Rather than constructing a new historical periodization, this study adopts the comparative-historical reconstruction developed by Lopez Jimenez et al. (2025). Their analysis identifies a sequence of Political Frameworks generated by completed Critical Junctures in Peru’s republican history, providing a theoretically grounded operationalization of the latent historical environments proposed in this paper. Employing an existing reconstruction also separates the development of the theoretical framework from the empirical operationalization of its historical constraints.

Following Lopez Jimenez et al. (2025), Peru’s republican history is organized into six Political Frameworks. Five correspond to completed Political Frameworks whose institutional legacies have become consolidated over time. The sixth represents an ongoing Political Framework associated with a Critical Juncture whose long-term institutional consequences remain unresolved. Consequently, the current Political Framework should be interpreted as provisional.

Table 3 summarizes the Political Frameworks employed throughout the empirical analyses. These define the successive historical environments within which Proposition P1 is evaluated.

The substantive importance of these Political Frameworks lies not in the historical events that generated them, but in the distinct historical environments they represent. Each framework embodies a different configuration of governing priorities, institutional capacities, and political incentives, thereby defining the organizational conditions under which governmental organizations operate.

Table 3*Operationalization of Political Frameworks*

Political Framework	Period	Originating Critical Juncture	Dominant Political Legacy
PF1 – State Formation	1824–1883	Independence (1810–1824)	Failed national state-building; persistent caudillo politics; colonial institutional continuities.
PF2 – Oligarchic State	1883–1933	War of the Pacific (1879–1883)	Elite reconstruction under oligarchic rule; patrimonial state consolidation and restricted political incorporation.
PF3 – Power-Sharing State	1933–1975	Crisis of the Aristocratic Republic (1920–1933)	Tripartite political order involving oligarchy, APRA, and the armed forces; gradual incorporation of organized social actors.
PF4 – Democratic Transition and Crisis	1975–1993	Military Revolution (1968–1975)	Democratization following military rule under conditions of economic collapse, political violence, and institutional crisis.
PF5 – Democracy without Parties	1993–2022	Fujimori Settlement (1982–1992)	Neoliberal political order characterized by weak parties, electoral volatility, and sustained executive predominance.
PF6 – Current Critical Juncture	2022–Present	Collapse of the Fujimori Settlement (2021–2022)	Fragmentation of the neoliberal political order; collapse of executive-legislative equilibrium; intensified social polarization; uncertain institutional realignment still in progress.

Note: The Political Frameworks presented here constitute the historical operationalization employed throughout the empirical analyses. They represent enduring political legacies inferred from completed Critical Junctures rather than observed historical categories. Alternative operationalizations are possible under different comparative-historical interpretations. Adapted from Lopez Jimenez et al. (2025).

Accordingly, the Political Frameworks summarized in Table 3 provide the empirical operationalization of the latent historical constraint introduced in the theoretical framework. They constitute the successive historical environments within which ministerial duration is compared to evaluate Proposition P1.

3.2 Operationalizing the Protective Belt

The theoretical framework defines Protective Belts as latent organizational constraint structures that preserve the conditions under which organizational knowledge may accumulate. Unlike Political Frameworks, which characterize the historical environment shared by all governmental organizations, Protective Belts are organization-specific. Their empirical application therefore requires identifying the observable organizational mechanisms through which these latent constraint structures are operationalized.

It is important to distinguish these two historical moments. The constitutional settlement of 1993 marks the beginning of the fifth Political Framework. The Pro-

tective Belt examined in this study, however, is conceptualized as an organizational architecture that developed within that Political Framework and reached sufficient operational consolidation only after the democratic transition of 2001. Using 2001 as the point of consolidation distinguishes the persistence of the organizational architecture from the political leadership that initiated its construction, allowing the analyses to evaluate whether the proposed organizational mechanisms remained operative beyond the Fujimori administration.

For the purposes of this study, the Protective Belt is operationalized through the selective organizational reconstruction of Peru's macroeconomic governance that followed the constitutional settlement of 1993. The Constitution itself did not create the Protective Belt. Rather, it established a new Political Framework by fundamentally redefining the constitutional relationship between the state and the economy. Earlier constitutions assigned the state an active role in economic planning, public enterprise, and direct participation in productive activities. By contrast, the 1993 Constitution constitutionally entrenched a Social Market Economy, limited state participation in business to a subsidiary role, strengthened the protection of private property and contracts, guaranteed equal treatment of domestic and foreign investment, and eliminated mandatory economic planning. Collectively, these provisions established the constitutional conditions under which a new system of macroeconomic governance could subsequently be constructed.

The organizational reconstruction unfolded progressively during the decade following the constitutional reform rather than immediately after it. Successive governments established an increasingly coherent architecture of fiscal, monetary, financial, and regulatory institutions capable of supporting macroeconomic stability and international economic integration (Santos et al., 2015). From the perspective of the present framework, this gradual organizational reconstruction constitutes the observable mechanism through which the Protective Belt surrounding macroeconomic governance is operationalized.

The Protective Belt should not be understood as protecting individual ministers from dismissal or eliminating political turnover. Rather, the progressively denser organizational architecture increased the institutional, administrative, political, and reputational costs associated with disrupting macroeconomic governance, thereby preserving the organizational conditions under which knowledge could accumulate despite recurrent ministerial replacement.

Because this organizational architecture emerged progressively rather than instantaneously, the present study assumes that the Protective Belt became sufficiently consolidated only after the democratic transition of 2001. Consequently, while the principal analyses evaluate ministerial continuity across the complete sequence of Political Frameworks, complementary analyses beginning in 2001 examine whether the observable implications of Proposition P2 become more clearly visible once the organizational mechanisms constituting the Protective Belt had substantially consolidated.

From the perspective of the present framework, these organizational reforms

constitute the observable mechanisms through which the Protective Belt surrounding macroeconomic governance is operationalized. They did not eliminate political turnover, nor did they protect individual ministers from dismissal. Rather, they progressively increased the institutional, administrative, political, and reputational costs associated with disrupting the organizations responsible for macroeconomic governance, thereby preserving the conditions under which organizational knowledge could accumulate despite recurrent ministerial replacement. Because this organizational architecture emerged progressively rather than instantaneously, the present study assumes that the Protective Belt became sufficiently consolidated only after the democratic transition of 2001. Consequently, while the principal analyses evaluate ministerial continuity across the complete sequence of Political Frameworks, complementary analyses beginning in 2001 examine whether the observable implications of Proposition P2 become more clearly visible once the organizational mechanisms constituting the Protective Belt had substantially consolidated.

This operationalization necessarily limits the empirical scope of the present study. Protective Belts are conceptualized as general organizational constraint structures that may emerge around different governmental organizations through distinct institutional, political, administrative, or societal mechanisms. The present analysis focuses exclusively on the Protective Belt surrounding Peru's macroeconomic governance because it represents an unusually explicit and well-documented process of organizational reconstruction. Consequently, the findings should not be interpreted as evaluating the existence or strength of Protective Belts throughout the Peruvian state. Rather, they examine a theoretically motivated empirical application in which the organizational mechanisms underlying a Protective Belt can be identified with considerable historical precision. Future applications of the framework may examine whether comparable Protective Belts emerged around other governmental organizations under different Political Frameworks.

3.3 Governmental Organizations as Analytical Units

The theoretical framework developed in this paper conceptualizes governmental organizations as the principal units through which organizational continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, and institutional learning are examined. Ministers temporarily occupy these organizations, whereas the organizations themselves persist across successive presidential administrations and Political Frameworks. Consequently, the empirical analyses compare governmental organizations rather than individual officeholders.

Each ministerial spell is observed simultaneously within three analytical contexts. First, it belongs to a governmental organization, which constitutes the organizational unit through which the theoretical mechanisms operate. Second, it occurs under a presidential administration, representing the executive context responsible for ministerial appointment and replacement. Third, both governmental organizations and presidential administrations operate within a Political Framework, which

defines the broader historical environment under which organizational continuity is evaluated. These contexts are analytically complementary rather than hierarchical, reflecting the intersection of organizational, executive, and historical processes.

The principal organizational comparison concerns the Ministry of Economy and Finance (MEF) and the Presidency of the Council of Ministers (PCM). This comparison is theoretically motivated because both organizations perform government-wide coordinating functions rather than sector-specific policy responsibilities. The MEF coordinates fiscal and macroeconomic governance across the executive, whereas the PCM coordinates cabinet action, executive–legislative relations, confidence votes, and the government’s overall political agenda under the constitutional and statutory framework established by the 1993 Constitution and the Organic Law of the Executive Branch (C. C. D. Perú, 1993; C. d. l. R. Perú, 2007, Arts. 122–127). Both therefore occupy central coordinating positions within the executive while performing fundamentally different coordinating roles.

The similarity between these organizations lies in their coordinating function rather than the substantive domains they govern. The difference lies in the organizational environments within which coordination occurs. During the decade following the constitutional settlement of 1993, successive governments progressively constructed a dense architecture of fiscal, monetary, financial, and regulatory institutions supporting macroeconomic governance. This reconstruction included fiscal rules, modern public financial management, an independent inflation-targeting central bank, strengthened financial supervision, and institutions promoting international trade and investment (Santos et al., 2015). Collectively, these reforms transformed the MEF into the organizational hub of Peru’s macroeconomic governance and progressively embedded it within the Protective Belt operationalized in the previous subsection.

By contrast, the PCM remained the executive’s principal organization for political coordination. Comparative research on political executives emphasizes that organizations occupying this coordinating position are responsible for managing cabinet conflict, steering government policy, maintaining legislative support, and responding to political crises (Grotz et al., 2021; Marland et al., 2025). In Peru, these responsibilities require continual adaptation to cabinet formation, executive–legislative bargaining, coalition management, confidence votes, and recurrent political crises. Consequently, the PCM remains directly exposed to the political dynamics that continually generate cabinet instability.

The comparison therefore contrasts two organizations that coordinate government as a whole but through fundamentally different organizational logics. The MEF coordinates a progressively institutionalized architecture of macroeconomic governance, whereas the PCM coordinates the political processes through which governments are formed, sustained, and reorganized.

This contrast provides the principal empirical evaluation of Proposition P2. The theoretical expectation is neither that macroeconomic governance is intrinsically more important than political coordination nor that ministers serving in one orga-

nization are necessarily more capable than those serving in the other. Rather, the comparison evaluates whether two governmental organizations performing similarly central coordinating functions exhibit systematically different patterns of ministerial continuity because they operate under different organizational constraint structures. If the proposed Protective Belt surrounding macroeconomic governance exists, its observable implications should be most apparent in the contrast between the MEF and the PCM.

Three additional governmental organizations are incorporated as comparative reference points: the Ministries of the Interior, Health, and Education. These organizations broaden the organizational scope of the empirical analyses by representing different combinations of political authority, technical specialization, administrative capacity, and public service delivery. Their inclusion serves two complementary purposes. First, they provide substantive benchmarks against which the MEF–PCM comparison may be interpreted. Second, they provide robustness checks against the possibility that the principal findings reflect idiosyncratic characteristics of the two focal organizations rather than the organizational mechanisms proposed by the theoretical framework.

The empirical analyses do not seek to demonstrate that one governmental organization is inherently superior to another, nor that longer ministerial tenure necessarily produces more effective public policy. Rather, they evaluate whether Peru’s historical trajectory exhibits observable patterns of ministerial duration consistent with the propositions derived from the theoretical framework. Ministerial duration remains the observable indicator of organizational continuity, while Political Frameworks and the operationalized Protective Belt define the historical and organizational constraint structures under which those observable patterns are interpreted.

4 Empirical Research Design

The empirical research design translates the observable implications of Propositions P1 and P2 into an analytical strategy. Because the theoretical framework is formulated in terms of latent organizational processes, empirical evaluation relies on ministerial duration as an observable indicator of organizational continuity under the historical and organizational constraints operationalized in the previous section.

Proposition P1 concerns historical variation across Political Frameworks. It evaluates whether successive Political Frameworks exhibit progressively longer patterns of ministerial duration, consistent with increasingly favorable conditions for organizational continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, and institutional learning. Proposition P2 concerns organizational variation within Political Frameworks. It evaluates whether governmental organizations operating under the same historical environment exhibit systematically different patterns of ministerial duration, consistent with differences in their organizational constraint structures.

Ministerial duration constitutes the natural observable for evaluating both propositions because it records the time elapsed between ministerial appointment

and departure from office. These observations are characterized by time-to-event outcomes, unequal exposure periods, and a small number of right-censored spells. Survival analysis therefore provides the appropriate statistical framework because it models the probability of remaining in office over time while explicitly accommodating censoring and differing observation periods.

Accordingly, the empirical strategy proceeds in two complementary stages. The first evaluates Proposition P1 by comparing survival patterns across Political Frameworks. The second evaluates Proposition P2 by comparing survival patterns across governmental organizations operating within the same Political Framework. Throughout both analyses, ministerial duration remains the observable outcome through which the theoretical propositions are evaluated.

4.1 Data

The empirical analyses use an original longitudinal dataset containing every ministerial appointment in Peru from the beginning of the republican period through the present. Each observation corresponds to one uninterrupted ministerial spell, beginning with the official appointment of a minister and ending upon replacement, resignation, dismissal, death, or administrative censoring at the end of the observation period.

For each ministerial spell, the dataset records the governmental organization, the presidential administration responsible for the appointment, the corresponding Political Framework, the date of entry into office, the date of exit, and the resulting duration of service measured in calendar days. Political Frameworks are assigned according to the operationalization developed in the previous section, while governmental organizations constitute the analytical units through which Proposition P2 is evaluated.

Table 4 summarizes the principal characteristics of the dataset employed throughout the empirical analyses.

Because a small number of ministers remained in office at the conclusion of the observation period, the dataset contains right-censored observations. Survival analysis explicitly accommodates this feature by distinguishing completed ministerial spells from observations whose termination has not yet been observed. Together with the unequal duration of ministerial service across observations, these characteristics make survival analysis the appropriate empirical framework for evaluating the propositions derived in the previous sections.

4.2 Observable Variables

Table 5 summarizes the observable variables employed throughout the empirical analyses, their analytical roles, and the propositions to which they contribute. Rather than measuring the latent theoretical constructs directly, these variables operationalize the observable comparisons implied by the deductive framework.

Table 4*Dataset Overview*

Item	Value
Unit of observation	Ministerial spell
Temporal coverage	1821–2026
Ministerial spells	1,069
Unique ministers	791
Presidents	124
Governmental organizations analyzed	MEF, Education, Interior, PCM, Health
Political Frameworks	6 Political Frameworks
Duration measure	Calendar days in office
Median duration	188.5 days
Mean duration	280.5 days
Duration range	1–2,059 days
Event definition	Exit from ministerial office
Right-censored observations	5

Note: The dataset contains one observation per ministerial spell. Duration is measured in calendar days in office. One day was added uniformly to all durations to avoid zero-length survival intervals. The event indicator equals one when a minister exited office and zero for right-censored observations.

4.3 Empirical Strategy

The empirical strategy follows directly from the two propositions derived from the theoretical framework. Although both propositions are evaluated using ministerial duration, they differ in the dimension along which continuity is compared.

Historical comparison (P1). Proposition P1 evaluates whether ministerial duration exhibits progressively longer patterns across successive Political Frameworks. Duration is therefore indexed by Political Framework (D_f), allowing continuity to be compared across historically distinct institutional environments. Kaplan–Meier estimators provide a non-parametric description of the survival trajectories, while pairwise Cox proportional hazards models evaluate the relative differences in ministerial survival across Political Frameworks.

Organizational comparison (P2). Proposition P2 evaluates whether ministerial duration differs systematically across governmental organizations operating within the same Political Framework. Ministerial duration is therefore indexed jointly by governmental organization and Political Framework (D_{of}), allowing organizational comparisons while holding the broader historical environment constant. Kaplan–Meier estimators describe the observed organizational survival trajectories, whereas pairwise Cox proportional hazards models quantify the relative hazards associated with each organizational comparison.

Taken together, these two analytical strategies evaluate the historical and organizational observable implications derived from the deductive framework. Throughout the analyses, ministerial duration remains the empirical outcome, while Orga-

Table 5*Observable Variables and Analytical Roles*

Observable variable	vari-	Analytical role	Proposition
Political work (PF_f)	Frame-	Indexes the historical environments within which ministerial duration is compared. It provides the historical partition required to evaluate changes in continuity across successive Political Frameworks.	P1
Governmental organization (O)	orga-	Indexes the organizational units within which ministerial duration is compared. Organizational comparisons are conducted within the same Political Framework to evaluate differences among governmental organizations operating under a common historical environment.	P2
Presidential administration (A)	admin-	Indexes the executive context within which ministerial appointments and replacements occur. Presidential administrations provide contextual information and allow the historical sequence of ministerial spells to be reconstructed.	Context
Ministerial duration (D)	dura-	Observed time in office measured in calendar days. Duration constitutes the observable approximation of organizational continuity and provides the empirical outcome evaluated throughout the survival analyses.	P1, P2

Note: Organizational continuity (C), organizational knowledge accumulation (K), institutional learning (IL), Political Frameworks (PF), and Protective Belts (PB) are theoretical constructs. Political Frameworks and Protective Belts are operationalized through the historical and organizational procedures described in the previous section, whereas ministerial duration provides the observable indicator of organizational continuity used to evaluate the propositions derived from the theoretical framework.

nizational Continuity, Organizational Knowledge Accumulation, Institutional Learning, Political Frameworks, and Protective Belts retain their status as theoretical constructs.

4.4 Survival Analysis

Ministerial duration constitutes time-to-event data characterized by unequal observation periods and a small number of right-censored observations. Survival analysis therefore provides the appropriate statistical framework because it models the probability that a minister remains in office over time while explicitly accommodating these features of the data.

The empirical analyses combine descriptive and inferential survival methods. Kaplan–Meier estimators provide non-parametric survival functions for each Political Framework and governmental organization, allowing the observable implications of Propositions P1 and P2 to be examined visually. Pairwise Cox proportional hazards models subsequently quantify the magnitude of the observed differences by estimating relative hazards between every combination of Political Frameworks or governmental organizations.

Rather than relying exclusively on a single reference-category specification, the empirical analyses combine pairwise comparisons with theory-driven reference models. Pairwise comparisons identify where historical or organizational differences emerge across all possible contrasts, whereas reference-category models evaluate the specific comparisons implied by Propositions P1 and P2. Together, these complementary approaches provide both exploratory coverage and direct tests of the deductive expectations developed in the theoretical framework.

5 Results

5.1 Proposition 1: Ministerial Duration across Political Frameworks

Proposition P1 predicts that successive Political Frameworks should exhibit progressively longer patterns of ministerial duration. Its observable implication is therefore that ministers serving under later Political Frameworks should exhibit higher survival probabilities over time than ministers serving under earlier Political Frameworks. Under Axioms A1 and A2, progressively longer ministerial duration is interpreted as evidence of increasingly favorable organizational conditions for organizational knowledge accumulation and institutional learning.

The empirical evaluation begins with a nonparametric comparison of ministerial survival across Political Frameworks.

5.1.1 *Kaplan–Meier Estimates*

Figure 2 presents the Kaplan–Meier survival estimates for the six Political Frameworks. If successive Political Frameworks generated increasingly favorable conditions for organizational continuity, later frameworks should exhibit survival curves

that lie systematically above those of earlier frameworks throughout most of the observation period.

The Kaplan–Meier estimates provide the first empirical assessment of Proposition P1. The proposition is deliberately formulated as a strong historical expectation: each successive Political Framework is expected to exhibit longer ministerial duration than its predecessor. Rather than asking whether continuity generally improves over time, this formulation identifies the specific historical environments in which the observable trajectory departs from a monotonic progression.

Figure 2 shows that the first four completed Political Frameworks broadly follow the expected historical ordering. Their survival functions shift progressively to the right, producing increasingly longer median ministerial durations,

$$PF_1 < PF_2 < PF_3 < PF_4.$$

This pattern is consistent with Proposition P1 and suggests that successive Political Frameworks generated progressively more favorable conditions for organizational continuity during most of Peru’s republican history.

The historical trajectory changes with the fifth Political Framework. Rather than extending the earlier progression, the post-1993 Political Framework exhibits a distinct survival pattern characterized by shorter median ministerial duration than both the third and fourth Political Frameworks. The sixth Political Framework displays an even shorter duration, although this result should be interpreted cautiously because it corresponds to an ongoing Critical Juncture whose institutional legacy remains unresolved.

From the perspective of the theoretical framework developed in this paper, this departure is theoretically informative rather than problematic. Proposition P1 evaluates whether Political Frameworks alone provide sufficient historical conditions for progressively greater organizational continuity. The interruption observed after 1993 suggests that historical environments, although necessary for understanding continuity, may not by themselves account for the observed ministerial survival patterns.

This interpretation does not challenge the comparative-historical reconstruction proposed by Lopez Jimenez et al. (2025). Rather, it evaluates a different question. Their framework identifies the enduring political legacies generated by successive Critical Junctures and provides the historical operationalization of Political Frameworks adopted throughout this study. The present analysis asks whether those historical environments also generated progressively more favorable organizational conditions for continuity and, consequently, for organizational knowledge accumulation and institutional learning.

The observed departure after 1993 therefore motivates the second proposition developed in the theoretical framework. If Political Frameworks alone cannot fully account for ministerial continuity, organizational differences within the same Political Framework become theoretically relevant. The following analyses examine whether

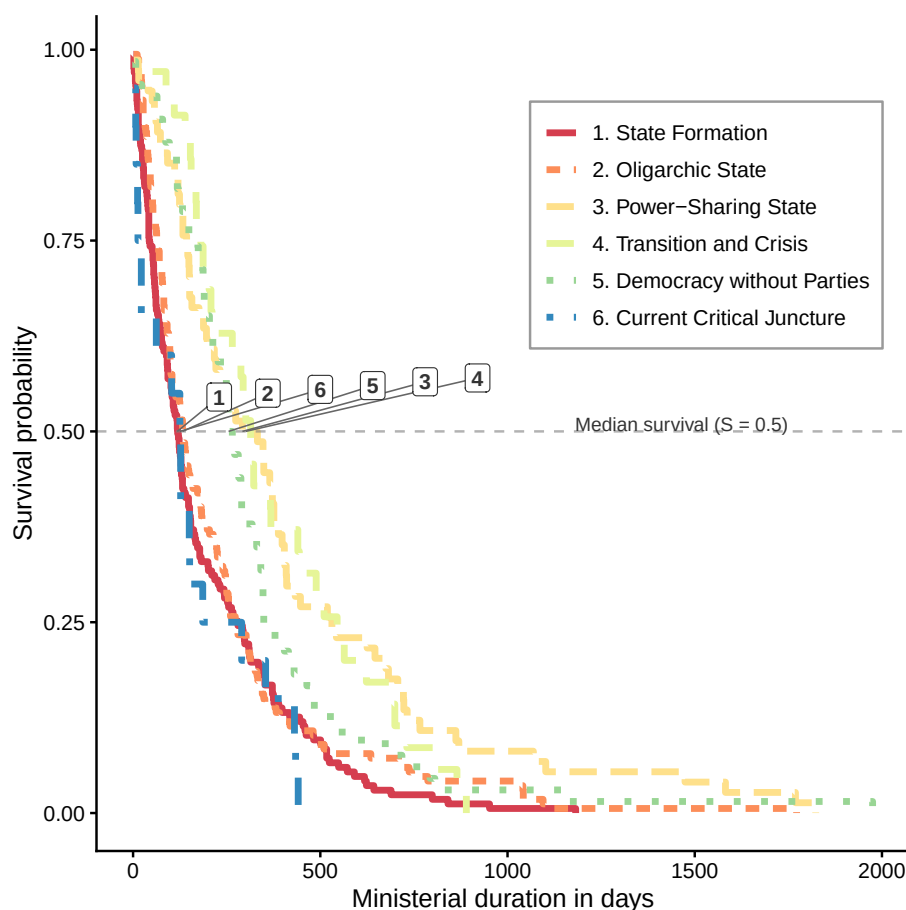


Figure 2

KaplanMeier estimates of ministerial continuity across political frameworks. Curves represent the estimated probability that a minister remains in office beyond a given duration. Numbers identify the six political frameworks listed in Table 3. Analyses are restricted to appointments to the Presidency of the Council of Ministers (PCM) and the Ministry of Economy and Finance (MEF).

introducing the Protective Belt as an organization-specific constraint helps explain the distinctive continuity patterns observed under the post-1993 Political Framework.

5.1.2 *Cox Proportional Hazards Model*

The Kaplan–Meier estimates describe the historical trajectory of ministerial survival, but they do not quantify the magnitude of the differences between Political Frameworks. To identify where the observed trajectory departs from the monotonic expectation implied by Proposition P1, Table 6 reports pairwise Cox proportional hazards comparisons across Political Frameworks.

Each cell reports the replacement hazard of the column Political Framework relative to the row Political Framework. Hazard ratios greater than one indicate that ministers serving under the column Political Framework faced a higher risk of replacement than ministers serving under the row Political Framework; hazard ratios below one indicate a lower risk of replacement. Because the matrix involves multiple pairwise comparisons, reported p -values are adjusted using the Holm procedure.

Table 6

Pairwise Cox Comparisons across Political Frameworks

Reference	2. Oligarchic State	3. Power-Sharing State	4. Transition and Crisis	5. Democracy without Parties	6. Current Critical Juncture
1. State Formation	0.88 (1.000)	0.47 (< .001)	0.50 (0.002)	0.61 (0.009)	1.24 (1.000)
2. Oligarchic State	—	0.55 (< .001)	0.58 (0.033)	0.65 (0.033)	1.31 (1.000)
3. Power-Sharing State	—	—	1.07 (1.000)	1.27 (1.000)	2.60 (0.003)
4. Transition and Crisis	—	—	—	1.30 (1.000)	3.35 (0.001)
5. Democracy without Parties	—	—	—	—	2.07 (0.040)

Note: Cells report hazard ratios from pairwise Cox proportional hazards models, with Holm-adjusted p -values in parentheses. Each row category is the reference group; each column category is the comparison group. Hazard ratios below one indicate lower ministerial replacement hazard in the column Political Framework relative to the row Political Framework. Analyses are restricted to PCM and MEF appointments.

The pairwise Cox comparisons confirm that the principal historical discontinuity separates the first two Political Frameworks from the subsequent completed Political Frameworks. Relative to PF1 and PF2, the hazards of ministerial replacement decline substantially under PF3, PF4, and PF5. However, the pairwise comparisons among PF3, PF4, and PF5 do not provide clear evidence of distinguishable replacement hazards. Rather than supporting a continuous stepwise increase in ministerial continuity, the evidence suggests the emergence of a new historical regime characterized by substantially greater organizational continuity than that observed during the first two Political Frameworks.

The sixth Political Framework departs sharply from this pattern. Its replacement hazard is clearly higher than those observed under PF3, PF4, and PF5, reinforcing the interpretation that the current Critical Juncture represents an unsettled historical environment rather than a completed Political Framework comparable to the previous periods.

Taken together, the Kaplan–Meier estimates and the pairwise Cox comparisons provide qualified support for Proposition P1. The evidence is inconsistent with the proposition’s strongest formulation, which requires a monotonic increase across every

successive Political Framework. Nevertheless, it supports the broader theoretical expectation that Peru’s organizational conditions for continuity improved substantially relative to the earliest historical environments. The main empirical pattern is therefore not continuous linear improvement, but a historical shift from the low-continuity environments of PF1 and PF2 toward the higher-continuity regime observed across PF3, PF4, and PF5. PF6 constitutes a separate disruption associated with an ongoing Critical Juncture.

5.2 Proposition 2: Ministerial Duration across Governmental Organizations within Political Frameworks

Proposition P2 examines whether governmental organizations operating under the same Political Framework exhibit systematically different patterns of ministerial continuity. Its observable implication is that ministerial duration should vary across governmental organizations despite their sharing the same historical environment. According to the theoretical framework developed in this paper, such differences are consistent with governmental organizations operating under different organizational constraint structures, represented here by the concept of Protective Belts.

The principal empirical application focuses on the Ministry of Economy and Finance (MEF) and the Presidency of the Council of Ministers (PCM). As discussed in Section 3, the post-1993 reconstruction of Peru’s macroeconomic institutions progressively consolidated a Protective Belt surrounding the MEF. Because this organizational consolidation was gradual, the comparison is organized around two periods: before and after 2001, when the principal institutional components of the macroeconomic governance architecture had become established. If the proposed Protective Belt exists, organizational differences between the MEF and the PCM should become observable only after this organizational architecture had substantially consolidated.

5.2.1 *Kaplan–Meier Estimates*

Figure 3 provides the first empirical assessment of Proposition P2. Rather than comparing different Political Frameworks, it compares ministerial continuity in the MEF and the PCM before and after the consolidation of the macroeconomic Protective Belt. If organizations embedded within stronger Protective Belts operate under more favorable conditions for organizational continuity, the survival functions should be similar before consolidation and diverge thereafter.

Figure 3 reveals virtually no difference in ministerial continuity between the MEF and the PCM before the consolidation of the macroeconomic Protective Belt. After 2001, however, the survival functions diverge systematically. Ministers serving in the MEF exhibit consistently higher survival probabilities than their counterparts in the PCM throughout most of the observed duration distribution.

This pattern is consistent with Proposition P2. Because both organizations operate under the same Political Framework during this period, the observed divergence cannot be attributed solely to the broader historical environment. Instead, it

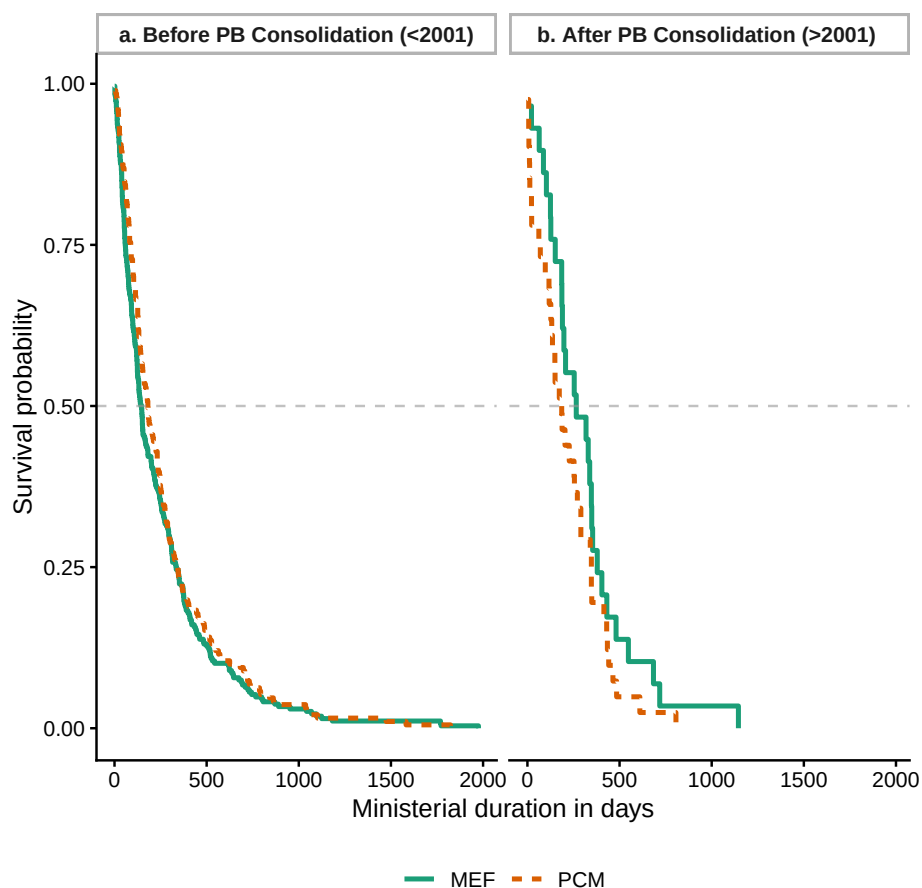


Figure 3

Kaplan–Meier estimates of ministerial continuity for the MEF and PCM before and after consolidation of the macroeconomic Protective Belt. Curves represent the estimated probability that a minister remains in office beyond a given duration. Facets distinguish spells before 2001 from spells beginning in 2001 onward.

is consistent with the proposition that organization-specific constraint structures became increasingly differentiated following the consolidation of Peru’s macroeconomic governance, providing more favorable organizational conditions for continuity within the MEF.

5.2.2 *Cox Proportional Hazards Model*

The Kaplan–Meier estimates indicate that ministerial continuity in the MEF and the PCM diverged following the consolidation of the macroeconomic Protective Belt, but they do not quantify the magnitude of this organizational difference. To estimate the relative hazards of ministerial replacement before and after Protective Belt consolidation, we estimate a Cox proportional hazards model including an interaction between governmental organization and period.

The interaction evaluates whether the relative replacement hazard of the PCM changed following the organizational consolidation of Peru’s macroeconomic governance. If Proposition P2 is correct, the PCM should exhibit a higher replacement hazard relative to the MEF after 2001 than before. Figure 4 summarizes the estimated hazard ratios and their 95% confidence intervals implied by the interaction model.

Figure 4 shows that before 2001 ministerial replacement hazards in the PCM and the MEF were nearly identical ($HR = 0.91$). Following the consolidation of the macroeconomic Protective Belt, however, the organizational difference widened considerably. The estimated replacement hazard for the PCM after 2001 was approximately 1.38 times that of the MEF ($0.91 \times 1.52 \approx 1.38$), indicating that the divergence observed in the Kaplan–Meier estimates corresponds to a substantially higher replacement hazard in the PCM once the Protective Belt had consolidated. This pattern is consistent with Proposition P2, which predicts that organizational continuity should diverge once organization-specific constraint structures become differentiated.

Additional governmental organizations. The principal test of Proposition P2 concerns the contrast between the MEF and the PCM because both perform executive-wide coordinating functions while operating under different organizational constraint structures. Figure 5 extends the analysis by incorporating the Ministries of the Interior, Education, and Health as comparative benchmarks. Separate Cox proportional hazards models are estimated before and after Protective Belt consolidation, using the MEF as the reference organization. If the organizational mechanism proposed by the theory extends beyond the PCM, portfolios operating outside the macroeconomic Protective Belt should exhibit increasingly higher replacement hazards relative to the MEF after 2001.

Figure 5 shows that before 2001 replacement hazards across the selected governmental organizations were broadly similar to those observed in the MEF. Following Protective Belt consolidation, however, the organizational pattern changes. Relative replacement hazards increase for the PCM, Interior, and Health, whereas Education exhibits comparatively little additional divergence from the MEF. The largest post-

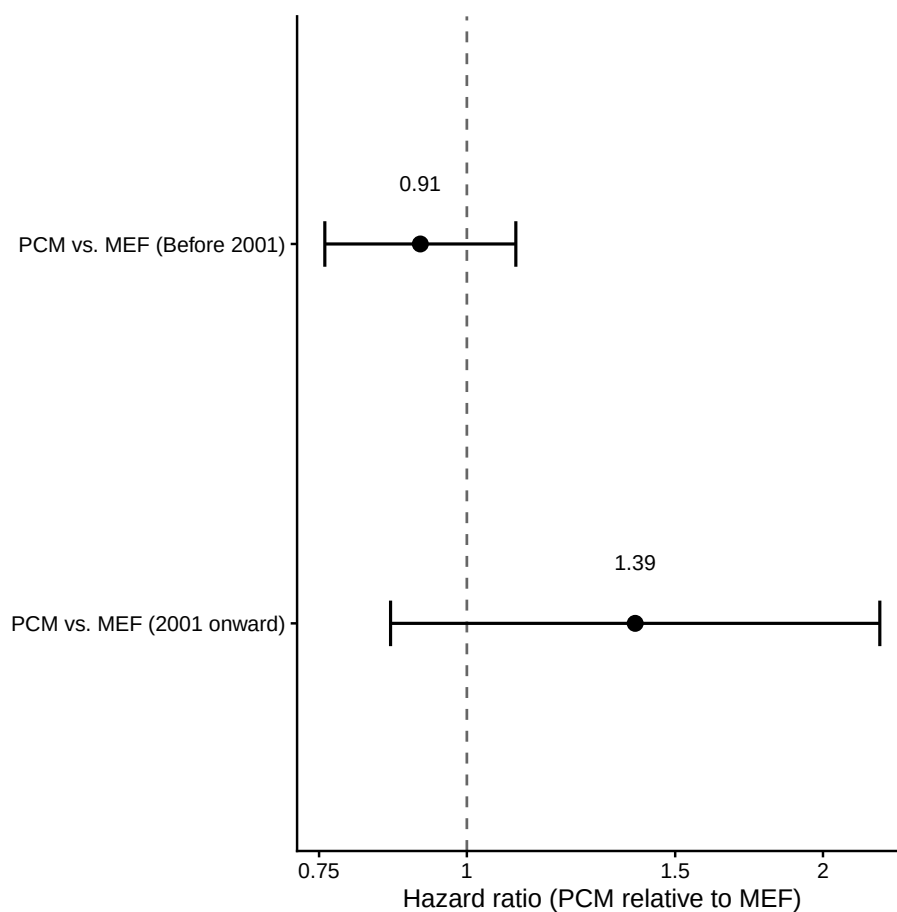


Figure 4

Hazard ratios comparing ministerial replacement in the PCM relative to the MEF before and after consolidation of the macroeconomic Protective Belt. Points indicate estimated hazard ratios from the interaction model, horizontal lines denote 95% confidence intervals, and the vertical dashed line indicates equal replacement hazards ($HR = 1$).

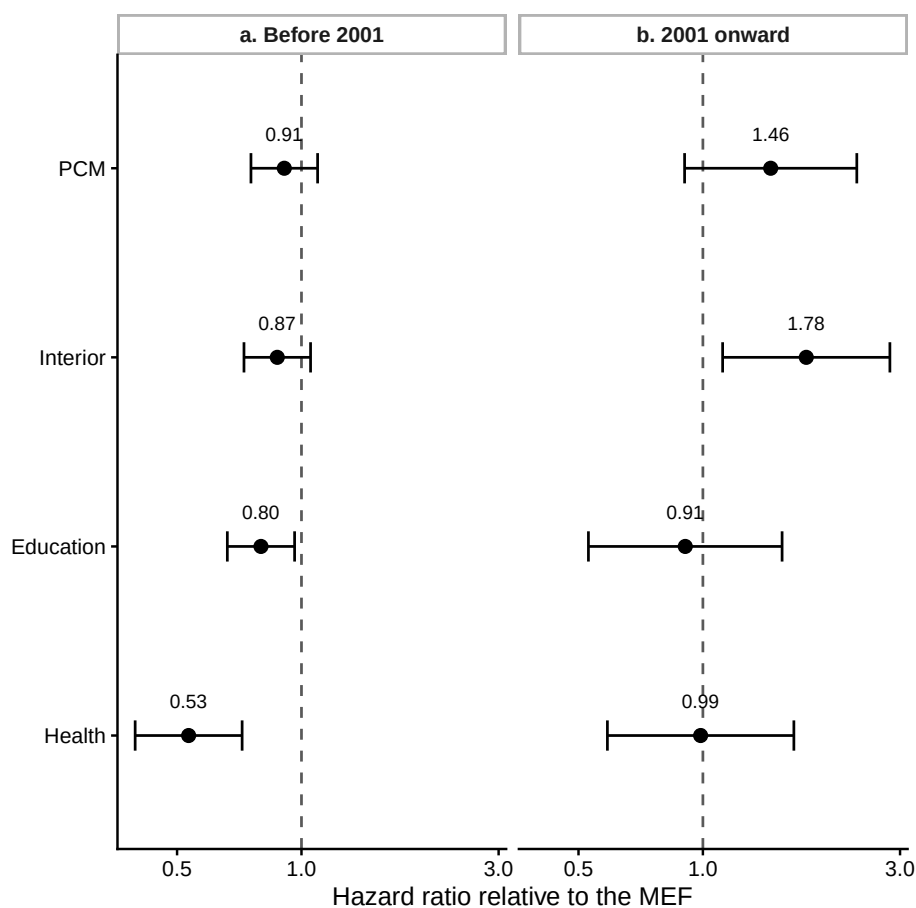


Figure 5

Cox proportional hazards estimates comparing ministerial replacement hazards relative to the Ministry of Economy and Finance (MEF) before 2001 and from 2001 onward. Points denote hazard ratios and horizontal lines indicate 95% confidence intervals. The vertical dashed line represents equal replacement hazards relative to the MEF (hazard ratio = 1).

2001 divergence appears in the Ministry of the Interior, followed by Health and the PCM.

These results reinforce the interpretation that the post-2001 organizational pattern is not simply a PCM–MEF contrast. Rather, the MEF becomes comparatively more stable relative to several governmental organizations once the macroeconomic Protective Belt has consolidated. At the same time, the heterogeneous organizational trajectories indicate that the Protective Belt should not be interpreted as a general theory of ministerial duration. Instead, it represents one organization-specific constraint structure operating within a broader set of historical and organizational processes. The remaining portfolios illustrate that organizations sharing the same Political Framework may nevertheless experience different continuity conditions depending on their organizational environments.

6 Discussion

The objective of this study was not merely to describe patterns of ministerial turnover in Peru, but to examine whether organizational continuity can be understood as the observable manifestation of deeper institutional processes. Building upon an axiomatic framework, the empirical analyses evaluated two propositions linking historical environments and organizational contexts to observable differences in ministerial duration. Taken together, the results suggest that political development alone provides only a partial explanation for organizational continuity. The evidence instead supports an organizational interpretation in which continuity emerges from the interaction between historical environments and organization-specific constraint structures.

6.1 Political Frameworks as Historical Conditions

The analyses provide qualified support for Proposition P1. Political Frameworks clearly matter. Ministerial continuity differs systematically across Peru’s successive historical environments, indicating that organizational continuity cannot be understood independently of broader political development. At the same time, the historical trajectory is not monotonic. Rather than exhibiting progressively longer ministerial duration across every successive Political Framework, continuity increases substantially from the first two Political Frameworks to the subsequent completed frameworks before declining during the contemporary period.

This finding has two theoretical implications. First, it reinforces the usefulness of Political Frameworks as historically grounded analytical environments within which governmental organizations operate. The comparative-historical reconstruction developed by Lopez Jimenez et al. (2025) therefore provides an appropriate historical operationalization for evaluating organizational propositions. Second, the interruption of the historical trajectory after the post-1993 settlement demonstrates that Political Frameworks alone are insufficient to explain organizational continuity. Historical envi-

ronments condition organizational development, but they do not uniquely determine how governmental organizations preserve accumulated knowledge over time.

The empirical analyses therefore suggest that historical institutionalism and organizational theory address complementary rather than competing dimensions of institutional development. Political Frameworks identify the historical environments created by Critical Junctures, whereas organizational continuity depends upon additional mechanisms operating within those environments.

6.2 Protective Belts and Selective Organizational Continuity

The second proposition was developed precisely to address this organizational dimension. Rather than assuming that all governmental organizations respond similarly to the same Political Framework, the theoretical framework proposed that organizations differ in the organizational constraints surrounding their accumulated knowledge. These constraints were conceptualized as Protective Belts.

The empirical evidence is broadly consistent with this interpretation. Prior to the consolidation of Peru's post-1990 macroeconomic institutions, the Ministry of Economy and Finance and the Presidency of the Council of Ministers exhibited remarkably similar patterns of ministerial continuity. Following the organizational consolidation of macroeconomic governance, however, ministerial continuity became systematically greater within the MEF. Additional organizational comparisons indicate that this pattern extends beyond the PCM alone, suggesting that the MEF became comparatively more insulated from ministerial replacement than several other governmental organizations.

These findings should not be interpreted as demonstrating that one governmental organization is more effective, more autonomous, or more normatively desirable than another. Nor do they imply that longer ministerial tenure necessarily produces better public policy. Rather, they suggest that governmental organizations differ in the extent to which organizational continuity itself becomes institutionally valuable. When accumulated organizational knowledge becomes central to the operation of a Political Framework, preserving organizational continuity may itself become an organizational objective. Under the present framework, such preservation constitutes the observable implication of comparatively stronger Protective Belts.

More generally, the results suggest that institutional learning should not be conceived as a property of political systems in the aggregate. Instead, institutional learning appears to emerge selectively through governmental organizations whose accumulated knowledge becomes sufficiently valuable to justify organizational protection. Organizational continuity therefore becomes an organizational characteristic rather than merely a historical one.

6.3 Bridging Historical Institutionalism and Organizational Theory

A broader contribution of this study lies in the integration of two research traditions that have often developed independently. Comparative-historical institutionalism has provided powerful explanations of institutional emergence, path dependence, and political development through concepts such as Critical Junctures. Organizational theory, in contrast, has focused on learning, routines, organizational memory, and knowledge accumulation within enduring organizations. Although both traditions address institutional persistence, they typically operate at different levels of analysis.

The framework developed here connects these perspectives by distinguishing historical environments from organizational mechanisms. Political Frameworks describe the historical contexts generated by Critical Junctures. Governmental organizations constitute the organizational units through which institutional continuity is observed. Protective Belts explain why organizations operating within the same Political Framework may nevertheless exhibit different trajectories of organizational continuity.

This distinction also clarifies the relationship between historical change and organizational persistence. Critical Junctures reorganize political authority and redefine Political Frameworks, but they need not affect all governmental organizations equally. Some organizations may become increasingly central to the operation of a new Political Framework, whereas others remain primarily exposed to short-term political pressures. The organizational consequences of political development therefore depend not only upon historical transformations themselves, but also upon the selective preservation of organizational knowledge within particular governmental organizations.

6.4 Scope Conditions

Several limitations define the scope of the present framework. First, the empirical application operationalizes only one Protective Belt associated with Peru's post-1990 macroeconomic governance. Other governmental organizations may develop different Protective Belts under different historical circumstances, and future research should examine whether similar organizational mechanisms emerge in other policy domains or political systems.

Second, the Political Frameworks employed throughout the analyses represent one theoretically informed historical operationalization derived from the comparative-historical reconstruction of Lopez Jimenez et al. (2025). Alternative historical operationalizations are possible and may generate different empirical partitions while remaining compatible with the deductive framework developed here.

Finally, ministerial duration should not be interpreted as institutional learning itself. Organizational continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, institutional learning, and Protective Belts remain latent theoretical constructs. Ministerial

duration constitutes only an observable indicator through which these broader organizational processes become empirically accessible. The contribution of the present study therefore lies less in the particular empirical indicator than in the deductive framework linking observable organizational continuity to underlying institutional processes.

7 Conclusion

This paper began from a simple observation: political systems often undergo profound institutional change while exhibiting remarkably stable patterns of organizational continuity and disruption. Existing research has provided powerful explanations of political development through concepts such as Critical Junctures and path dependence, yet comparatively less attention has been devoted to explaining how organizational continuity emerges within the historical environments created by those transformations. Addressing this problem required distinguishing the historical conditions under which governmental organizations operate from the organizational mechanisms through which institutional learning becomes possible.

To address this problem, the paper developed an axiomatic–deductive framework linking four latent theoretical constructs—organizational continuity, organizational knowledge accumulation, institutional learning, and Protective Belts—to observable empirical implications. Political Frameworks were introduced as historically grounded environments derived from the institutional legacies of successive Critical Junctures, whereas governmental organizations were conceptualized as the organizational units through which continuity becomes observable. Within this framework, ministerial duration is interpreted not as institutional learning itself, but as an observable indicator of the organizational conditions under which institutional learning may emerge.

The empirical application to Peru provides support for this theoretical distinction. Political Frameworks explain important historical differences in ministerial continuity, but they do not fully account for the observed organizational trajectories. The interruption of the historical progression following the 1993 constitutional settlement suggests that historical environments alone cannot explain organizational continuity. Introducing the concept of the Protective Belt helps account for this pattern by recognizing that governmental organizations operating under the same Political Framework may nevertheless face different organizational constraint structures. The comparative evidence indicates that the Ministry of Economy and Finance became progressively more protected than organizations primarily responsible for political coordination, consistent with the proposition that organizational continuity develops selectively rather than uniformly across the state.

More broadly, the framework contributes to ongoing efforts to integrate comparative-historical institutionalism with organizational theory. Political Frameworks identify the historical environments within which organizations evolve, whereas Protective Belts explain why organizations embedded within those same environments

may nevertheless exhibit different capacities for preserving organizational continuity and accumulated knowledge over time. Institutional learning therefore emerges neither as an automatic consequence of political development nor as an inherent property of governmental organizations, but as the product of the interaction between historical environments and organization-specific mechanisms of continuity.

The argument advanced here remains intentionally modest. The empirical analyses operationalize only one Protective Belt associated with Peru's post-1990 macroeconomic governance, and ministerial duration represents only one observable indicator of broader organizational processes. Both the historical operationalization of Political Frameworks and the organizational operationalization of Protective Belts remain open to refinement and extension in future research. The framework proposed here is therefore intended less as a definitive explanation than as a foundation upon which alternative historical settings, governmental organizations, and empirical indicators may be systematically incorporated.

Ultimately, the principal contribution of this study lies not in explaining Peru alone, but in providing a deductive framework through which institutional learning may be inferred from observable organizational continuity and examined comparatively across political systems. Rather than attempting to observe institutional learning directly, the framework specifies the organizational conditions under which it becomes theoretically plausible and empirically accessible. By distinguishing latent organizational processes from their observable implications, it offers a common deductive language for investigating how states preserve, accumulate, and transmit institutional capabilities despite recurrent political change.

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